

Aroostook County

Adams, Lorette Agnes

MARS HILL

I am running to seek a position as a delegate as a lifelong Democrat that has volunteered repeatedly over the years to further the causes of social justice, affordable living in our country. Having run for local office in the past I feel a strong responsibility to do what I can to help defeat Susan Collins in a real and tangible way and I am prepared to serve in this capacity and not simply monetarily. Please consider me for this position. Thank you.

Agrella, Randel Anthony

Defeating Collins is imperative but it isn't the only necessity. We must continue to build on the progressive momentum that was manifested by the Platner campaign. We need a candidate who can do both. Business-as-usual is no longer an option.

BIPOC

Anderson, Wanda L

WOODLAND

I have been a strong voice for equality for all underserved people and communities throughout my career as a social worker. I have spent my career advocating, serving and helping in numerous capacities. I am currently retired from UNE although I still support and mentor new social workers across the country. I am excited to share my voice as we work to replace and defeat Susan Collins. I will lend my voice and my time and show up to do the whatever work is necessary.

Asam, Katherine M

PRESQUE ISLE

I served as a delegate at the original Democratic convention in May, and would like to serve again this time. As a non-binary, disabled person living in northern Maine, I have a somewhat different perspective on the political race than both most Democrats I know in Aroostook, as well as most liberal Mainers in general. Unlike the majority of Maine Democrats in the primary, I did not vote for Platner (he was third of four in my ranking). The conversation around him prior to the primary was enough to give me pause about voting for him outright, though I was prepared to do so in the general election. That said, I understand why Platner was a popular candidate: he understood the deeply local nature of Maine politics, and met voters where they were instead of expecting them to come to him. I

also understand why Collins, a native of northern Maine and the scion of an old logging family up here, has had such staying power in Maine. A lot of people in Aroostook really know her in a way that they rarely know Maine's Democratic candidates for her seat. I would like to continue to contribute my perspective and voice in the election process at this nominating convention, to try to ensure that we select someone who can meet Mainers where they are, rather than someone who expects Maine voters to come to them.

LGBTQIA+, Disability, Youth

Asam, Margaret M

PRESQUE ISLE

I have been an involved supporter for several years, driving canvassers, being a canvasser myself, driving in local parades (in my hybrid), and hosting like minded groups in my home.

Asam, Richard H

PRESQUE ISLE

I have served as Aroostook County Democratic Committee's treasurer for five years and will strive to continue to do so. I have served as a delegate to several Democratic conventions and wish to represent those in The County who are unable, due to other obligations, to do so. While health issues preclude my canvassing door to door I will support and assist those who are able to. I know the upcoming senatorial campaign is critical for Maine's and the Nation's well being and will work to support our candidates. I am committed to replacing Senator Susan Collins.

Disability

Ashby, Jefferson T

PRESQUE ISLE

I want to defeat Susan Collins.

Betit, Charles J

FORT FAIRFIELD

I want to make sure the primary voters' will is honored. There was unprecedented energy and excitement during the primary. This was due to clear populist positions, a willingness to speak truth to power, the ability to engage directly with voters where they are throughout the state in person, and the ability to explain in practical ways how change is made and power is built. The path to unseating an entrenched incumbent has been shown and the candidate must have these attributes to connect with voters in order to be competitive with this late start. The candidate must be an agent of change to engage and expand the grassroots energy. I want to make sure a candidate who most closely

resembles these qualities is selected and the momentum isn't squandered. There is no way to replicate the 10-month plus campaign that just occurred, but I believe the lessons from it are clear in what excites and expands Democratic support and, to the best of our abilities, we make sure what's been successful is continued.

Brewer, Carol

STOCKHOLM

I am the Vice Chair of the Aroostook County Democrat Committee. I worked as a local organizer for canvassing for Graham Platner. I believe that his platform is what is needed for Maine and will work tirelessly for the candidate that is chosen to remove Susan Collins from office. This grassroots movement is critical in standing strong against Trump I will continue to work on building this movement even after the election.

Bryan, Jan Custer

CORINTH

I see the Trump administration as the most serious challenge to traditional American freedom and justice that has happened in my lifetime. The most influential thing Maine can do in this next election is to replace Susan Collins with a Democrat.

Carpenter, Michael E

HOULTON

I very much want the right person to be nominated so that we can defeat Senator Collins in November

Charette, Paula

FORT KENT

Voting for a strong candidate with a history of government understanding, service and leadership is the most critical aspect of a successful candidate. My own personal involvement within the organization and campaign is essential to the development of the campaign. I will be an active contributor and plan to host home gatherings, phone banking, and attend all events that are available to me. I plan on bringing more people who support the candidate and the campaign. We must defeat Susan Collins.

Chase, Pamela Frazier

PRESQUE ISLE

My interest in serving as a delegate to the nominating convention is to do be able to elect the most qualified candidate to run against Susan Collins this November. I have served the Maine Democratic Party here in Maine and Washington State on the state committee, as well as serving as a member of the select board for the town of Liberty, and working on house and senate campaigns at the state and federal levels. I have followed Shenna's life choices and career since 2002, when still in college she led the GOTV effort in Hancock County. What she has done since the 2014 election has been commendable. I am committed to doing everything to help her win this U.S. Senate seat to the best of my ability by making phone calls, these auto dialer programs allow us to do much more in a short amount of time. I will knock on doors to talk to voters directly, throughout the campaign and for the GOTV part which is so crucial. To help our party build on the grass roots momentum I would not only recruit others to volunteer but training them and actually accompanying them as they get started. My passionate faith in our system of government and the individual's responsibility guides me in what I do despite what we have had to endure under this administration. Shenna Bellows had proven her passion for the rule of law and can stand up to Trump like no other.

Conlogue, Jon

HOULTON

I am 67 years old and this is undoubtedly the most important election in my lifetime. As a lifelong Democrat who was born in the County and returned here several years ago, I believe that the DEMOCRATIC party must get back to its roots as the people's party and connect with voters if our nation is to survive and stop its descent into oligarchy. To do that, we must throw off the corporate, insular image that makes us seem like an only slightly less unpalatable alternative to the GOP. Graham Platner can no longer be the messenger; but the enthusiasm and support he generated makes clear that he had the right message, and we absolutely need that energy to win this race. Susan Collins is an embarrassment and a sellout and we MUST defeat her in November (and also prevent carpetbagger Paul LePage from winning the House race). I'm ready to work.

Daffin, Robert

CARIBOU

I am a resident of Caribou and I would like to help determine who wins against Collins. I have 3 candidates in mind but I will back whoever is chosen to beat Collins.

DeFelice, John F

PRESQUE ISLE

It is critical that the Democrats gain a majority in the Senate to defeat the Trump authoritarian and racist agenda that cuts across decades of civil rights and democratic processes. In particular the rights of women and the compassion towards millions of immigrants must be considered as well as the rights of marginalized people. The agenda of Project 2025 must be met and defeated by representative bodies. We must also stand for the separation of church and state. I have 30 years of experience as a professor of history and political science in the University of Maine at Presque Isle. I stand with the people being targeted by this wayward administration. To defeat Susan Collins, we must expose her connections with inside trading, her submission to Donald Trump in January 2025, her lack of judgement in supporting Supreme Court Candidates, and her lack of awareness of the needs of the people of Aroostook County and Maine.

DeMaio, Stephen

EASTON

I would like to help choose the candidate best suited to defeat Collins. I'd also like to help the party avoid its usual circular firing squad.

Devesu, Peggy

WOODLAND

Listen,I am chopping at the bit to get Troy elected! I attended a House Party in Presque Isle and met him.Troy has my respect and we need him! Let's f'ing go!

Farrin, Jayne Rheta

PRESQUE ISLE

I strongly agree with the progressive movement of the former candidate, including universal health care, curbing money in elections, and the taming of Wall Street. The candidate should be able to clearly express, motivate, and most importantly inspire voters, including those who identify as independents. The candidate needs to have the energy and ability to campaign statewide through the November election. The candidate needs to be bold. As a delegate to the Nominating Convention, I would do my best to ensure that the issues important to the progressive movement are not forgotten. Since retiring as a municipal clerk, I have returned to my Democratic roots by participating in the city and county Democratic Committees, volunteering at the local party office, writing postcards, attending local protests, and, in 2025, participating in the statewide "Vote NO on Question 1" campaign. We as Democrats must unite behind a candidate so that we can achieve our all embracing

goal of defeating Susan Collins. I commit to volunteering and advocating for the candidate selected by the Nominating Meeting.

Foster, Nicholas S

I would like to serve as a delegate at the Nominating Convention because as a Mainer I am sick of the status quo. The cost of living, the casual and not so casual degradation of immigrants and people of color, inflation, the war that nobody wanted or approved, the horrible atrocities of this administration- it is completely the opposite of everything I stand for as a citizen and a human being. We cannot allow Collins another term and that is why I am running.

Gartley, George H

PRESQUE ISLE

I was part of the Platner campaign from day one. I served on the advisory board. I put in hundreds of volunteer hours. I feel that if those who worked the hardest for Graham Platner's vision of the future are shut out of this process then the Democratic Party will lose many disillusioned members. The fact that this is happening at all is an insult to democracy. The voters should have had the right to judge Graham's moral character, not the power elite.

Gartley, Marcia A

PRESQUE ISLE

I am one of the 156,000 who voted for platner. I was on his advisory board. If we are going to prove this works we need to stay in the fight.

Gerritsen, James

BRIDGEWATER

I will support Troy Jackson at the convention. As a lifelong New Deal Democrat I've been an Organic farmer at 'Wood Prairie Family Farm' for 50 years. I was first elected Dem Town Chair for Bridgewater in 2004, serving continuously since then. As a delegate to the Maine Dem conventions in 2016, and again in 2018, I stood alongside Troy to support Bernie Sanders for president. I worked closely with Troy in 2013 when he championed Maine's right-to-know GMO labeling bill and successfully passed it to become the second-in-the-nation GMO Labeling law. In 2021, I worked with Troy to pass his landmark bill in both Houses of the legislature that would have banned the aerial spraying of Glyphosate on Maine's industrial forest. I know Troy to be a fearless and effective leader who brings people together and stands up against greedy corporations and wealthy elites, fighting for the interests of working people in Maine. Troy is true to his word and he gets things done. Troy is Maine's

best hope for beating Susan Collins. Vote for me as a delegate and I will work for and help elect Troy Jackson for U.S. Senate. Thank you.

Gordon, Dale Johnson

CARIBOU

I already submitted this statement.

Disability, Underrepresented Religion

Gould-Leighton, Susan

FORT FAIRFIELD

Many of my friends know that my mother was working in the Truman White House when I was born, so I really can say I'm a lifelong progressive Democrat and have worked for the party in many capacities, including as a delegate for Bernie Sanders, as a whip for Jesse Jackson and I served on the state committee for several years. I was not really expecting to get back involved, but Troy makes it worth it. I have known Troy for at least 10 years and have always seen him as working for the values I hold dear. He is the one to beat Susan Collins. I ask you to vote for me as a delegate.

Haines, Rommy L Jr

FORT FAIRFIELD

I have worked on fall election campaigns for more than 40 years, been elected to the DSC 5 times, and been employed by the unified campaign twice. I prefer to knock on doors these days because I think it is the most effective tactic today. Having said that the most important single thing that needs to be done is to get a great candidate to sell at the doors. That is why I want to be a Jackson delegate.

Hamlin, Elliot

PRESQUE ISLE

I believe we need someone with a similar platform and the ability to excite voters if we want to have any chance to defeat Susan Collins. As someone who grew up in Aroostook but spent time living in Massachusetts and Germany I've seen what a difference it makes when the government works to protect and support people instead of billionaires and corporate interests. Picking a centrist candidate would be a waste of the current grassroots enthusiasm and would risk alienating the very people who came out in record numbers to vote for Platner in the primary. If selected as a delegate I would make sure to carefully consider all the candidates and the opinions of the people of Aroostook. While there are candidates, like Bellows, Jackson, and Loud, whom I am more familiar with and ranked highly in the primaries, I am open to considering other candidates. In the unfortunate event that my (and the Aroostook Democrat's) preferred candidates don't make it through earlier rounds of voting I

would make an effort to vote for the best of those that remain. I believe it is always worth it to vote, but I understand the frustration of feeling there are no good options, so I would do my best to make it so Mainers going to vote in November feel they have a good candidate.

LGBTQIA+, Disability, Youth

Hastings, Whitney

PRESQUE ISLE

I am non binary democrat who has lived in Aroostook County my whole life. I care about my community and am highly motivated as a mother and member of this community to make sure we have a senator who represents the people and is able to defeat the very concerned Susan Collins.

LGBTQIA+

Henninger, Mikaela

PRESQUE ISLE

I'm a currently working as a rural community organizer with Maine People's Alliance and have spent the last year and a half organizing progressive folks in the county. For the first time ever progressive Dems in my area have started to create a political home. I have spoken with folks door knocking, spent time organizing tenants rights groups, facilitating chapter meetings and building trust within community. I think I'd be a great delegate for representing a group in Aroostook that feels particularly unheard. I think I bring a unique view as a raised Republican, growing up in Susan's town where I lost my salon due to a landlord buying my building and doubling my rent. I've written Susan and called multiple times. My friend interned for her in high school and worked for her during the Kavanaugh incident where she lost all faith in Susan too. I have my own stories and the stories of a lot of County residents across all walks of life. I think I have a voice worth hearing.

LGBTQIA+, Disability, Youth

Hines, Ryan

HAMMOND

The 2026 election cycle has had some great Democratic heros. It is very unfortunate that Graham has a dark history that caused him to cease his campaign. I believe there are a few great options to replace Graham and I would be honored to be part of the nomination and electoral process. It is vital that we replace Susan Collins in the US Senate with a Democrat from Maine. Collins has not been helping her vast number of constituents, but perhaps has helped a few in her very Trump tainted policies. I believe we can nominate a winnable Democrat. Thank you for your consideration.

Hoppe, Kathy M

PORTAGE LAKE

Maine and our nation are at a critical moment. We must take decisive steps to defend our democracy, our republic and the rule of law, or allow the erosion of Nation to continue. I believe Senator Susan Collins has enabled this erosion, making the November 2026 election critical to not only restoring democratic norms and advancing policies that put citizens first. Delegates to the Democratic Nominating Convention will have the important responsibility of helping nominate the candidate best positioned to build the broad coalition needed to defeat Susan Collins in November. I am willing to take on that responsibility. As someone who has been active in my community, I know that lasting success is built through strong local networks. I have seen firsthand that meaningful, thoughtful conversations—and listening carefully to voters—can change minds and inspire action. I plan to volunteer my time through data and text banking, canvassing, networking, and encouraging others in my community to become involved in the campaign. I understand that serving as a delegate would be both an honor and a responsibility. I would proudly represent my community, help select a strong Democratic nominee, and work to elect that nominee and defeat Susan Collins in November.

Hunt, Patrick E

ISLAND FALLS

I plan to support Troy Jackson as our nominee and hope those who also support him will select me as a delegate. I want to ensure we nominate a candidate for Senate via a process that is maximally democratic and respects the will of the voters. Given the highly unusual circumstances, Democrats cannot afford a situation that appears compromised by backroom deals or excessive party influence. I appreciate everything that party leadership has done so far to facilitate as smooth and transparent a process as possible.

Johnson, Bonnie

LIMESTONE

Being a lifelong resident of Aroostook County, Maine, and a Democrat, I would honor the opportunity to join the Democratic Delegation to select a Democratic Senate candidate that can unseat Susan Collins. I believe this is a crucial moment and I advocate for choosing a candidate who can appeal to a broad range of voters, including Liberals, Democrats, Independents, and some Republicans, to ensure victory. Together we will prevail & I hope you will consider me as part of the team. ????????

Johnson, Kelly

HOULTON

I have been a proud registered Democrat my entire adult life. In this moment, our state has come to a crossroads that will help determine the future of our small communities, our state and our country. I believe that has a delegate at the nominating convention, it will be my responsibility to represent my fellow democrats of my community as well as the rest of Aroostook County. I believe with my conviction, to fight against the strong hold of Susan Collins. I will assist in forging a strong collaboration, that will choose the next freshman Senator from Maine.

Langworthy, Adam MacMonegle

FORT FAIRFIELD

As a progressive Mainer I have a vested interest in the outcomes of our elections. I want to be a part of the change toward a more progressive Maine if I could. Getting Susan Collins out and replaced by a progressive candidate is what matters in this coming election.

Langworthy, Diane

FORT FAIRFIELD

I want to participate in close listening to other Democrats. As a former supporter of Platner, I am reeling from the pain of losing a candidate who demonstrated listening and the ability to speak strongly to values that drew me to the Democratic Party in the first place. The platform of Platner's campaign reached across parties and called to independents. We need a candidate who does not make excuses for or accept money from Oligarchs and supporters of genocide. It is time to actually listen, dare to hope anew, and build a coalition that reaches out. I will campaign door to door and speak publicly every way I can to defeat the vicious policies from which Collins has callously grown wealthy, while lying and trampling our most vulnerable. Bodily autonomy for women cannot be compromised.

Lapointe, Gabrielle

WESTON

I plan to support Dr. Nirav Shah as our nominee. I am running to be a delegate to ensure we nominate a candidate that can actually win the general election in November and defeat Susan Collins once and for all. I am excited for the opportunity to participate in this democratic process and will take my responsibility as a voting delegate seriously.

LeClaire, Sarah Elizabeth

WOODLAND

I am going to do what I can to assure that the selection process is as fair and as representative of the will of Aroostook Count voters as can be - given that we just had our free and fair Primary Election trashed with -O- input from the people.

Levasseur, Temika

MADAWASKA

I want to ensure we nominate a candidate for Senate via a process that is maximally democratic and respects the will of the voters. Given the highly unusual circumstances, Democrats cannot afford a situation that appears compromised by backroom deals or excessive party influence. I appreciate everything that party leadership has done so far to facilitate as smooth and transparent a process as possible. I plan to support Troy Jackson as our nominee and hope those who also support him will select me as a delegate.

LGBTQIA+

Little, Danny

MADAWASKA

I am a supporter of Troy Jackson and I believe he is the best democrat to defeat Susan Collins. I support Troy because he is progressive. He promotes Medicare for all which is much needed. Troy is a union supporter who understands working people. Troy has strong progressive ideas to stand up to billionaires to keep them from buying elections and politicians. His presence in the US senate would keep the current regime from destroying our country.

LGBTQIA+

Lowell, William C

BRIDGEWATER

I was a deligate to the spring convention. <https://youtu.be/icVbrbWsx8Q?is=gNp0BnQhf4LIG550>
Sorta says it all.

Madore, Jimmy D

VAN BUREN

As a lifelong Democratic person, I wish to become a delegate to this convention based on common sense. I also want to be part of a process that is fair and impartial to all.

LGBTQIA+

Martin, Roland D D

CROSS LAKE TWP

It is vital that we select a candidate that will defeat Susan Collins

Martinez, Julie

LIMESTONE

As a resident of Aroostook County, I am running to serve as a Democratic delegate because our rural, working-class communities deserve a fierce, unapologetic voice. While I may not have been born in Maine, I have made this County my home, and am deeply invested in its people, its heritage, and its future. I am stepping forward because I believe our political system must champion the working class from the bottom up, not the top down. For too long, the economic divide has widened while career politicians cater to corporate interests and the wealthy elite. I want to stand up for everyday families who feel left behind by the status quo. I center on fighting for policies that keep our local industries thriving, ensure public investments prioritize local workers, and provide real tax relief to families who need it most. Furthermore, I am committed to addressing the structural crises holding our rural communities back. This means fighting to lower healthcare and prescription drug costs, tackling the housing shortage, capping child care costs to support young families, and protecting our environment from corporate exploitation. Aroostook County embodies hard work, resilience, and community. I am running to ensure those values are fiercely represented, to build a Democratic party that stands shoulder-to-shoulder with labor and unions, and to advocate for an economy that works for everyone, not just those at the very top.

McAtee, Katelyn Fitzpatrick

LITTLETON

I'm tired of being embarrassed of Susan Collin's and want to show Maine what a real ally from Aroostook county looks like! Troy makes me proud to be from the county!

McBreairty, Clayton

ALLAGASH

I have watched Troy Jackson over the years fight tirelessly for everyday working class people. He genuinely cares about the issues that are important to us. We need him in Washington to fight for us.

McBreairty, Colleen

ALLAGASH

We need a progressive candidate to defeat Collins. Troy Jackson has been fighting for the working class, and marginalized groups his whole career. He never backs down, he will stand up to the Trump administration.

McGary, Ethan

OAKFIELD

Being from northern Maine and living in a heavily republican town (Oakfield) I'd love to represent the democrats and make my voice heard

McIntosh, Michael James

WASHBURN

Defeating Susan Collins; taking one or both Houses of Congress in 2026; challenging Trump's authoritarian takeover of the United States: these should be the goals of every American who believes in the real American Dream of equality and freedom for all, not just for old, white, men who happen to be Republican. That said. I am not young. I am pinkish-white. I am a man. And, I was born a Republican and expected to die a Republican. At the behest of one of the current senatorial nomination candidates, I switched parties to vote for them in a Democratic primary. Then Republicans lost their minds, betrayed everything I believed about the importance of character. They nominated LePage for governor and they nominated Trump for president. Today I am committed Democrat. My contribution to defeating Susan Collins will be to continue an eleven-year anti-MAGA advocacy among my family and friends; to donate to her challenger's campaign; and to push everyone I know to vote in November. I will attend rallies. I will volunteer for the challenger's campaign. Grassroots momentum in an existential crisis cannot be expanding the party in only one direction. It must include inroads into the other party's base. People like me can speak to that. Representation and inclusion ought to put at least a few never-Trump, ex-Republicans in the room in Bangor to pick the best person to defeat Collins. But whether I am one of them or not: I will do everything I can to win in November.

McIntosh, Noreen

WASHBURN

I'm very politically aware through a lifetime of study and learning. My Dad, Jim McBreaity, was deeply involved in local and state politics and I represented Olympia Snowe in Aroostook County for 2 1/2 years. These two examples taught me to be thoughtful and fair and partisanship was not an issue with either of them. I have been a registered Democrat for many years, and I'm horrified by what has been happening to our country in recent years. Susan Collins has taken some very destructive votes, and in the remainder of the trump administration she has the opportunity to take many more. I have no particular plans on how to defeat her in November, but will do whatever I can (legally) to make that happen. The future of our country hangs in the balance!!!

McLaughlin, Vaughn James

FORT FAIRFIELD

I am seeking to serve as a delegate to the Maine Democratic Nominating Convention because I believe this is a pivotal moment for our party and for the future of Maine. As the Democratic candidate for Maine State Senate District 1, I understand the importance of selecting a nominee who can unite Democrats, inspire voters, and build the coalition necessary to defeat Susan Collins in November. My commitment to public service has been shaped by 39 years as a Maine public school music educator, seven years as president of the Caribou teachers' union, and my experience farming in Aroostook County. Those experiences taught me the value of hard work, community, and standing up for working families. Throughout my campaign, I will actively support Democratic candidates at every level of the ballot. I will continue meeting with voters across Aroostook County, listening to their concerns, and focusing on issues that matter most to rural Maine: protecting our schools, hospitals, and nursing homes, strengthening revenue sharing for struggling communities, reducing the property tax burden, and ensuring that working people have a strong voice in Augusta and Washington. Grassroots organizing is built one conversation at a time. I will help expand our party's momentum by engaging voters, encouraging civic participation, and demonstrating that Democrats are committed to improving the lives of everyday Mainers. Together, we can elect leaders who will put people and communities first.

Michaud, Beau

FORT KENT

Being a delegate is important to me because I want to ensure Planter's replacement is someone who can continue his movement. Platner's message was simple: the system is broken, and Donald Trump and all the harm he has caused are simply a symptom of that broken system. His message was true; our broken system caters to only the richest Americans while everyone else becomes worse off in every way. Platner identified something that struck a chord with Democrats and independent voters alike. Especially as a young person, Platner's message resonated with me, giving me hope that change

may happen. Platner's replacement needs to be someone who has a reputation of fighting for working and middle-class people, not someone who has suddenly become progressive the moment Platner dropped out. Platner's replacement needs to be someone who will continue the movement Platner built. As a young person, I hope to have a hand in the future of my party. To help defeat Susan Collins in November, I plan to volunteer with whoever replaces Platner. Hopefully, his replacement is someone who ignites as much excitement as Platner did. To help continue building the grassroots momentum within the party, I will continue to push for change. One day, I want to see the Democratic Party as the party that rejects corporate PAC money and fights for the needs of working Americans. Only by nominating candidates with messages similar to Platner's will this grassroots momentum continue to grow.

Miller, Ruth

FORT FAIRFIELD

I'm committed to progressive values.

Moulton, Emily

HOULTON

I am eager to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention to help select strong, principled candidates who prioritize Maine families, fiscal responsibility, and individual liberties over entrenched Washington interests. I've seen how real change starts with engaged citizens, not career politicians. To help defeat Susan Collins in November, I am part of a group here in Houlton and Presque Isle and have volunteered on Graham Platner's campaign by phone tree. We'll emphasize accountability and fresh leadership that better reflects Maine values. I will build on our party's grassroots momentum by training new volunteers, expanding digital organizing tools, and fostering inclusive coalitions that welcome independents and disaffected voters. I take notice that Susan has not made efforts past Eastport or even goes to her office in Presque Isle. Together, we can sustain energy beyond election day, grow local committees, and create lasting infrastructure for future wins. I'm ready to represent our community with integrity and urgency.

Mountain, Shelly A

MAPLETON

I am running to be a delegate to support Troy Jackson. I am a former Chair of the Aroostook County Democrats and have known Troy for many years. He has always been a champion for working people. Troy has the ability to attract diverse groups to work on common goals. He is the only one I know who can get my husband to trek up to Soldier Pond on Friday nights to work on organizing loggers. He is a strong progressive unafraid to take on big corporations. He has taken on Irving to stop the aerial spraying of glyphosate and to stop their unfair labor practices. He has challenged pharmaceutical companies over high medication costs. Troy supports and has worked for a form of single payer

healthcare. He has a 100% rating from Planned Parenthood because he knows the importance of protecting women's reproductive rights. He's also willing to challenge Democratic Party leadership. He was the only Maine "superdelegate" at the 2016 national convention to vote for Bernie Sanders, even though Bernie won over 64% of the vote in Maine. Beyond all of this, Troy genuinely cares about the people he serves. He listens to their needs and does all he can to help them. People have come into local offices over the years and told me their stories of how he has helped them. Importantly, the candidate must win the whole state and Troy is in the best position to win against Susan Collins.

Paradis, Samantha

FORT KENT

My name is Dr. Samantha Paradis, DNP, MPH, FNP-C, CARN-AP, I live in Fort Kent, and I am running to be a delegate for the nominating committee. We are in a crucial time in our history as a country and a state. I believe we need bold leaders to ensure an equitable future for our children. At a time when the billionaire class is influencing elections and the authoritarian regime is taking steps to dismantle our protections as working class people; our voices are more important than ever. I have been participating in the Senate race as a volunteer, and I plan to keep this momentum and support as we select our next candidate. We need a candidate with a history of supporting progressive causes and human rights, such as healthcare for all, climate action, reproductive care, unions, immigrant rights, and LGBTQ+ people. I am a genderqueer nurse practitioner working full-time in addiction medicine, a parent to two children, a previous mayor of Belfast, Maine, and a board member of the Maine Women's Lobby. I believe my unique lived experience brings value to the decision-making table. I kindly request your confidence and vote to serve as a delegate in this nomination process.

LGBTQIA+, Youth

Paradis, Stacy

FRENCHVILLE

I am honored to seek election as a delegate to support Troy Jackson for the United States Senate. Troy embodies the values that define the Maine Democratic Party—honesty, hard work, equality, and a steadfast commitment to working families. He has always fought for rural communities, defended workers' rights, and advocated for policies that ensure everyone has the opportunity to succeed. I would be proud to help nominate and support a progressive leader who consistently puts people first. My background has prepared me to represent our party with integrity and dedication. I hold degrees in Criminal Justice and Rural Public Safety, with a minor in Behavioral Science, and I am also a trained nurse. These experiences have given me a deep understanding of healthcare, public safety, and the unique challenges facing Maine's rural communities. They have strengthened my commitment to fairness, compassion, and evidence-based decision-making. As a delegate, I will represent Democratic values with professionalism and respect while working to ensure every voice is heard. I believe my education, professional experience, and commitment to humanity make me well-qualified to serve. It would be an honor to represent Maine Democrats and stand alongside Troy Jackson as we

work toward a more just, equitable, and prosperous future for all.

Disability

Pelkey, Eric J

CARIBOU

As a community college instructor, I want to help ensure that my students will be able to stay in Maine and thrive. It's important that the hope and enthusiasm that was poured into the Platner campaign doesn't dissipate, and that our party selects the candidate who best embodies our state's progressive, compassionate values. I would take my role as a delegate seriously and use the nominating as an opportunity to connect with fellow Democrats around the state.

Potter, David M

FORT KENT

I started listening to Senator Bernie Sanders in February 2025 and have remained involved in the progressive movement to save our democracy for 17 months. This commitment reflects my personal belief that I share some of the responsibility for the state of our Democracy. While an active voter, like millions of others, I've been complacent and have not engaged with our elected officials or paid attention to national issues and initiatives. And here we are. Now I am an active supporter of Indivisible, American Promise, Common Cause, No Kings and have supported numerous individual candidates across the country with modest donations. In September 2025, I began writing letters to our Congressional Delegation on the entire array of significant national issues. If it's of any use, I'd be happy to share with you a dozen response letters from Susan Collins on specific issues, but I'm sure you already know where she stands. I almost never listen to the legacy media recognizing that they are the lion's share of the US propaganda machinery. Much of my direction from comes from the non-legacy sources like Adam Kinzinger, Marc Elias, Glenn Kirshner, Heather Cox Richardson, Ezra Levin, Leah Greenberg, etc. In these sources I find credibility, fact-based reporting and inspiration. I'm prepared to dedicate 4 hours per week or more to respectfully unseat Susan Collins. Among my interests are writing LTE's, advocating for the candidate at public events, getting signs put up, speaking to local civic groups, working GOTV efforts, transportation to polls, etc.

Reese, Melanie Ann

PRESQUE ISLE

My work history with the Maine Democratic Party is lengthy and varied. In an effort to save the reader time I will present in a list form some of what I have and am continuing to do to insure Democrats are elected into local, State, and national offices. 1) former Vic. Chair of the Presque Isle Democrats 2) active member of the Aroostook County Dems. 3) delegate at the past two State Democratic Conventions and attended both. 4) I organize and work candidate forums and debates. 5) I organized and worked at our local Democratic Caucuses 6) make signage and attend local rallies and

demonstrations. 7) maned democratic tables at local festivals and local events. 8) go into high schools and colleges and help students register to vote. 9) hosted numerous house parties for local and state candidates. 10) attend local city council meeting and reach out to news stations and papers when controversial topics are being discussed to insure their attendance and coverage of the issues. 11)help encourage and recruit candidates to run for local and state boards and offices. 12) match and drive with the Democrats in local parades. 23) work to promote democratic candidates and events on social media where my viewership is often 3000 or more. (not always that high but often)

Reeves, John

MADAWASKA

I'm going to support Troy Jackson at the convention. Troy is for the working class people, being a logger from here in Northern Maine he knows what working families need to survive. He also supports Medicare for ALL, which I strongly support. Troy will carry on the fight to rid billionaires from controlling our elections keeping them from buying off certain candidates who only serve the rich. Troy is for the over-spending on forever wars and will focus more on the needs of the people of Maine and the USA. The fact that Bernie Sanders is endorsing Troy tells me Troy is a good progressive Democrat who will beat Susan Collins in the mid-term election. I supported Troy for Governor of Maine because he refused to accept corporate money and he did quite well.

Rossignol, Jordyn

CARIBOU

I want to ensure we nominate a candidate for Senate via a process that is maximally democratic and respects the will of the voters. Given the highly unusual circumstances, Democrats cannot afford a situation that appears compromised by backroom deals or excessive party influence. I appreciate everything that party leadership has done so far to facilitate as smooth and transparent a process as possible. I plan to support Troy Jackson as our nominee and hope those who also support him will select me as

Roy, Roger A

CARIBOU

This is too important6 not to participate in. I have been volunteering as a Democrat since my father volunteered me to pass out literature for Adlai Stevenson in 1952.

Saucier, David A

VAN BUREN

I have been a Democrat since I was a young boy and believe strongly in the democratic platform. We need to defeat Collins and fight for democracy. I can fight for this party. I was newly elected to the SAD31 school board in the middle of a redistricting battle. I was told by other board members to let this go through. I told them that I was elected for the best interest of the students but was outnumbered. I had an open mind in hopes that the merge would be beneficial by offering more services but that was not the case. It was only in the interest of the tax payers. I discovered that there were secret meetings between the school boards and the Maine State Board wanting us to be a trial run for RSU. After I exposed this, what began as a handful of community members attending board meetings turned to an entire gymnasium with press being present and community questioning the boards. After I made a motion to sue the Maine State Board of Education, seconded and approved by the majority, the state backed down and distributed the funds to fix the school after they had previously condemned it. The school remains over a decade later. I will fight fearlessly to remove Collins. She doesn't have the best interest of Maine citizens but for her party. All potential candidates would be a better choice.

Serafin, Peter

FORT KENT

250 Words is not enough to describe anywhere near the degree of passion in which I feel about this subject. Democrats as a whole need to regroup and consolidate in the face of what could be the last opportunity we have to get this country back on track. Rights have been systemically peeled away, injustices allowed to go unanswered, and accountability thrown to the wayside. Senator Susan Collins is part of that problem; her responses to the deaths of innocent Americans is abhorrent and shows the disconnect between our current elected officials and their constituents. When I first moved to Maine in 2022, Troy Jackson greeted me and my family to Aroostook county. Troy Jackson stepped up to act as a beacon for progressives to rally around in the wake of Graham Platner withdrawing his nomination from the race. I reiterate once more, 250 words is not enough to fully state how important this moment is. There is far too much 'I told you so' rhetoric amongst Democrats, far too many splinters when we're facing a wall. If we, as Americans, want to get our country back we **MUST** rally. The first step in this process is trust and accountability. Taking this first step means trusting in the process that Maine Democrats will not allow outside DNC influence, and not throwing the entire process into the garbage. That would be quitting and we cannot afford to quit. I fully support Troy Jackson to be my United States Senator.

LGBTQIA+, Immigrant/New Mainer, Youth

Tompkins, Melanie

MAPLETON

As an active Democrat who worked hard for multiple candidates during this election cycle, I would like the opportunity to be part of selecting our next nominee for Senate. As someone who has worked with many of the potential candidates, I am informed on this vote. I am extremely engaged throughout Aroostook county as a cofounder of Aroostook Organizers for Change and know what it takes to energize and mobilize folks. I will continue to work hard and be sure Democrats are successful across the ticket in November.

Youth

Trudel, Leo L

STOCKHOLM

I would be honored to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because Maine Democrats must unite behind a strong candidate who understands working families, rural communities, and the challenges facing people throughout our state. As an university educator, small-business owner, and former economic development director, I have spent my career helping people build better opportunities for themselves and their communities. I will approach this responsibility thoughtfully, independently, and with a commitment to selecting the candidate best prepared to defeat Susan Collins. After the convention, I will actively support our nominee by communicating with voters, encouraging volunteer participation, attending community events, using my personal and professional networks, and helping the campaign reach people in northern and rural Maine. Defeating Susan Collins will require more than advertising; it will require trusted local conversations about healthcare, education, economic opportunity, Social Security, veterans, and the future of our democracy. Our party must also preserve and expand the grassroots momentum already created across Maine. I will help welcome new volunteers, listen respectfully to voters with different perspectives, and encourage Democrats to remain engaged beyond a single election. By organizing locally, supporting Democratic candidates at every level, and keeping our message focused on the needs of Maine people, we can build a stronger and more unified party.

Underwood-Charette, Janel

PRESQUE ISLE

In the past year and a half I have been more actively engaged in politics and community organizing. This is an urgent and concerning time in our country, and I feel it necessary to be working to support positive change. As a woman, mother, grandmother, social worker and community member I am choosing to take action to support the change I want to see in the world to improve quality of life and equality for all. Being involved in bringing forth quality candidates to win and change our political reality is fundamentally important. Having discourse and conversations about issues, candidates, and policy is a necessary part of getting people more involved and informed. I've been engaged in some

way with most campaigns this season as well as planning/hosting numerous events and would be happy to participate in successfully moving our party through this challenging moment to victory.